

10 Myths about PROGRAMMERS

Programmers are...

- 1** **Myth:** Big on caffeine and nicotine
Reality: Blame the movies for this stereotype—those celluloid nerds that you see aren't us! We don't need gallons of coffee or chain smoking to keep all that code flowing. That comes from the great repository in our brains, which doesn't need to be chemically 'inspired'. So stop spoiling our scope for marriage, will you?
- 2** **Myth:** Fast food junkies
Reality: Let's clear that image straight off. We enjoy the occasional binge of parathas and dosas as much as you do! Being true blue Indians, we are just as picky about what we put in our mouths. Get rid of that pizza swallowing, cola guzzling image of a programmer. After all, our *dil maange* more as well!
- 3** **Myth:** All about code—stupid is as stupid does!
Reality: Nah! Most of us are talented and knowledgeable people in more areas than just programming. We are ordinary people like you except that we came with a built-in taste for programming! We have our opinions on everything under the sun just like you do. Sit down to a tête-à-tête with a programmer and he/she will probably talk circles around you!
- 4** **Myth:** Male chauvinists
Reality: That couldn't be farther from the truth! There are more of the fair sex among us than you know. We believe in equality of the sexes, buddy (and it makes the work place that much more visually appealing!). But seriously, girls are much better programmers than guys at times. The only scenario wherein we might oppose women programmers in the vicinity is if you insist on surrounding us with pictures of babies and stuffed animals!
- 5** **Myth:** The ones with the most stable jobs
Reality: Off target again. Our chances of having a stable job are just about the same as yours. Survival of the fittest is the name of the game. The IT slowdown had created a scenario where people were being laid off in thousands. But those are days of yore. Now a programming job is a stable and lucrative option.
- 6** **Myth:** Loaded with the green stuff
Reality: Money never did grow on trees. There were times when even HTML coders used to rake in hefty paychecks. Not any more. Our salaries are comparable to any other job now. They aren't as sky high as you would like to believe.
- 7** **Myth:** The ones with fancy techie degrees under their belt
Reality: Let's clear this myth spread by B.Techs and MCAs. Well, it does help in getting a better pay packet if you have these, but it's not a must-have. Programming is something that comes from within. Almost like those army recruitment ads, "Do you have it in you"?
- 8** **Myth:** The know-alls in programming
Reality: Although we would like it to be so, programmers aren't always the Yoda of coding. Each of us is a specialist in the kind of programming we do. Of course, this depends on the project that we are working on. We learn new skills if the project calls for them. The only thing we consider stable are our programming fundamentals, which remain the same whatever programming language or tools we use.
- 9** **Myth:** Great at handling entire projects single-handed
Reality: Even if it were so, we prefer parallel processing. It's much better when many heads work on a complex problem than a single one, isn't it? That's our *modus operandi* as well. Projects are split into parts and different teams of programmers work on them. Besides, this is also the reason that we don't run into too many late nights at the office!
- 1** **Myth:** Not interested in women
Reality: Well...would love to talk about that at length but got to rush. Have a date with Julie and then dinner with Priya. Shucks, social life's more hectic than coding! 📧

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